



Manchester City has partnered with Sony to create immersive fan experiences in the metaverse (Courtesy: Manchester City)

someone speaks to you in a foreign language, it can help with navigation, take pictures, and play music, among other things. TCL said the glasses will first be available to the developer community, before it is ready for the public.

Companies like Brelyon and 3D Game Market showcased headset-free virtual monitors or 3D screens, which let you experience immersive content without wearing any cumbersome glasses; while HTC showcased a high-end VR headset to compete with Meta's. OVR unveiled a headset with an aroma cartridge that has eight aromas, which can be combined with each other to create many more aromas. This adds a sense of smell to the immersive VR experience. They said the headsets will be available in the market later this year.

Samsung and LG showcased smart televisions with blockchain integrations, such as NFT wallets and marketplaces. Unstoppable Domains, a San Francisco based company building domains on blockchains, demonstrated crypto wallets, blockchain domains, and other such offerings that it said were the gateway into Web3. For enterprises, there were some awesome productivity-oriented metaverse

tools from players like FORUM8 and Dentsu NXT Space.

All in all, a very interesting year for metaverse enthusiasts at CES!

Metaverse news, from the tech world

Last month, Meta organised a Zoom call with ad agencies to help them understand the concept of the metaverse. They spoke about the concept of mixed reality (MR), a merging of the virtual and physical worlds, wherein a person wearing an MR headset can trigger a virtual world reaction using a real-world object. Meta told advertisers that MR could start to become a reality for consumers in a few years. Right now, MR headsets are too expensive for people to indulge in.

Indian-American Neal Mohan recently took over as YouTube's CEO. Last year, as the company's Chief Product Officer, he chalked out plans to integrate metaverse based content experiences and content tokenisation via NFTs, thereby giving creators more ways to engage with fans and monetise their content. Mohan is still very optimistic about the metaverse, and with him at the helm, metaverse trend watchers feel these plans might be realised faster.

And, of course, everyone is talking about how AI is going to help create the metaverse faster, and how it is going to make it more effective. A TIME magazine author who was researching on this, wrote to Sean Ellul, Co-founder of Metaverse Architects. He got a well-written five-paragraph email response giving almost every detail he needed.

But, wait! In the fourth paragraph, the email revealed that it had been written by ChatGPT itself. It had responded to Ellul's simple prompt: "Write an email to Andrew, from TIME, about how at the company Metaverse Architects we are using ChatGPT to brainstorm code, prepare articles, and ideate new projects. We even use it to write emails, such as this one!" Indeed, AI tools like ChatGPT are likely to make interactions much more natural and informative in the metaverse.

On the other hand, AI systems like DALL-E, Midjourney, Magic3D, and DreamFusion—which can create realistic images and art from a description in natural language—will make the creation of the metaverse incredibly fast. Imagine how easy it would be if users just wrote a paragraph or verbally discussed their ideas about a virtual space and it was created instantly by AI tools. This would not only speed up the creation of the metaverse but also let users create their spaces the way they want them to be, without having any technical knowledge.

"We're able to fill the Internet with interesting stuff because everybody is capable of taking a picture, recording a video, or writing words," said Rev Lebedian, Vice President for Omniverse and Simulation Technology at Nvidia, to TIME magazine. "If we are going to create a 3D Internet, then you absolutely have to have the people who are participating in it creating